

What to automate first

This is a placeholder.

The worksheet itself is being finished. The address you gave us is on the list, and the real thing will reach you as soon as it exists.

In the meantime, the short version:

1. Time the task, do not estimate it. The one that feels expensive and the one that is expensive are rarely the same task.
2. Count the handoffs. Work that crosses three people costs more in waiting than in doing.
3. Ask what happens when it goes wrong. If nobody knows, that is the thing to fix before automating any of it.
4. Automate the boring middle, never the judgement at either end.

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